Priscilla Muiuane
Women in Product International Women's Day Hackathon

✦ CONSTELLATION CONNECT ✦

Portfolio Case Study

Women in Product Hackathon • March 2026

5	4	~100	5
Days to ship	Team members	AI credits total	User flows built

01: Project Overview

Constellation Connect is a mobile-first networking and mentorship app built for professional communities, starting with Women in Product and with the potential to scale to other communities. The product solves two distinct but related problems: the friction of capturing meaningful conference connections, and the lack of a trusted, curated platform for mentorship matching within the Women in Product community.

The app introduces a constellation metaphor to reframe how we think about professional relationships:

- Star = a user on the platform
- Sparkle = an interaction between users
- Constellation = a collection of interactions tied to a specific event
- Shooting Star = a connection so meaningful it becomes a mentorship recommendation
- Star Search = the ability to find and connect with other users

Built in under 96 hours using Lovable AI — a prompt-driven no-code prototyping tool none of us had used before — the team shipped a working, demo-ready product with five fully functional user flows.

02: My Role

I served as product and technical lead. While the team operated as a flat peer structure, I drove product strategy, the build process, and cross-team coordination from Day 1 through submission.

Title	Product & Technical Lead
Responsibilities	Feature prioritization, prompt engineering strategy, build coordination, technical risk management, presentation scripting
Team	Priscilla (Me) Shirley, Trinity, and Brandi — all women, all BIPOC, across 3 time zones

Tools	Lovable AI, Miro, Google Docs, Zoom, Perplexity AI, Gamma AI
Timeline	Sunday March 22 — Wednesday March 26, 2026
Live app	constellationconnect.lovable.app

03: Problem Statement

Professional growth depends on two foundational activities: making connections and finding guidance. Yet today's tools fail at both. Conferences generate bursts of high-value interaction, but no structured system exists to capture who you met, what mattered, or what you intended to do next. The tools professionals reach for — LinkedIn, notes apps, business card photos — are fragmented and discard the emotional and contextual signals that make a connection worth following up on. Within days of an event, names, topics, and intentions vanish. Hosts face the same blind spot in reverse: they cannot gauge real-time engagement or know whether their session created any lasting impact.

04: Target Users

Conference Attendee	Women in product roles attending Women in Product, Women in Tech, or similar events. Motivated by authentic long-term relationships, not just collecting LinkedIn connections. Expects high-quality networking tools as part of her conference value.
Mentee	Recent grad, career switcher, or professional returning after a break. Struggling with imposter syndrome; actively seeking senior guidance. Willing to pay ~$200/year for verified access to quality mentors.
Mentor	Senior executive or experienced product leader in the Women in Product community. Selective about who they network with; values trust signals over volume. May charge for their time; values the platform's exclusivity.
Conference Organizer	Chapter leads and event managers. Needs to register attendees, track engagement analytics, view NPS, and understand whether their events are creating lasting professional impact.

05: User Journeys

All four user journeys were mapped in Miro before any Lovable prompts were written. This grounded every build decision in actual user behavior, not feature lists.

Conference Attendee — User Journey							
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Receive app invite	Register for conference	Create profile	Attend event	Meet someone	Log the Sparkle	View Constellation	Follow up

Key attendee-specific features: guided prompts for logging interactions (what stood out, what you talked about, connection strength), ability to add event takeaways, tour of how to use the app before the first event, and constellation view sortable by date or custom fields like mentor topics.

Mentee — User Journey							
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Download app	Verify identity	Create profile	Star Search	Request connect	Answer prompts	Meet mentor	Add session notes

Key mentee-specific features: Star Search to find users by custom field, guided questions to facilitate interactions, option to optionally share notes with the other user, and integration with personal calendar to save meeting schedules.

Mentor — User Journey							
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Download app	Create profile	Receive request	Accept or deny	Set questions	Meet mentee	Add session notes	Answer questions

Key mentor-specific features: incoming mentorship request management (accept/deny), ability to define questions that guide each interaction, and private session notes after each meeting.

Conference Organizer — User Journey							
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Create profile	Create conference	Collect attendee info	Register attendees	Send invite email	Approve new users	View analytics	View feedback

Key organizer-specific features: full analytics dashboard per conference (registrations, connection counts, NPS), ability to approve or reject users for community access, and constellation-level testimonials that can be used to market future events.

06: PRD & Feature Prioritization

Requirements were gathered and prioritized in Miro using a P0–P3 framework. The team added all potential features as sticky notes, then moved them into priority tiers before any build work began. This process — not the AI tool — was what kept us on scope.

Feature / Requirement	Rationale	Priority
Constellation visualization	The defining metaphor — event-based star maps. Without it, the app is just a contact list.	**P0 — Must Have**
Contact logging with prompts	Reflective prompts capture emotional/contextual metadata that sets this apart from notes apps.	**P0 — Must Have**
Event-anchored constellations	Organizing contacts by specific conference/event is core to the product's UX logic.	**P0 — Must Have**
Mentorship onboarding survey	Required foundation for any matching logic — without this there is nothing to match on.	**P0 — Must Have**
Private notes (user-only)	Privacy-by-default must be present from day one — not added later.	**P0 — Must Have**
Safety flags & negative feedback	Needed before any significant user base, especially with vulnerable users seeking mentors.	**P0 — Must Have**
Guided onboarding tour	Users may be confused by the constellation/star format — guided intro is essential.	**P0 — Must Have**
Search (contact/event/industry)	Without search, the constellation becomes a visual archive with no action path.	**P0 — Must Have**
Star sizing by connection quality	Enriches the visual metaphor and surfaces high-value contacts at a glance.	**P0 — Must Have**
Mentor/mentee swipe interface	Swipe UX reduces decision friction and is core to mentorship discovery.	**P1 — Should Have**
30-minute call scheduling	The match means nothing without a path to an actual conversation — this is the conversion moment.	**P1 — Should Have**
Follow-up reminder nudges	Solving post-conference memory loss requires timely prompts, not just passive storage.	**P1 — Should Have**
Virtual event mode	Expands reach beyond in-person attendees. Intentionally deferred to Phase 2.	**P2 — Could Have**
Multi-factor authentication	Strong security hygiene. Acceptable to defer for hackathon prototype.	**P2 — Could Have**

Community access gating	Verification that users are Women in Product members is essential to exclusivity and mentor trust.	**Gap — Needs Definition**
Profile completeness indicator	Drives quality data entry which directly improves match quality.	**Gap — Needs Definition**
QR code / business card scan	Speeds up contact creation in fast-paced conference environments.	**Gap — Needs Definition**
LinkedIn integration (login)	Reduces logging friction. OAuth complexity makes this a Phase 2 bet.	**Future Phase**
AI-generated follow-up drafts	Reduces friction to re-engage, but risks feeling impersonal in a high-trust community.	**Future Phase**
End-of-year constellation recap	Spotify Wrapped-style summary of connections and mentorship stats.	**Future Phase**
Premium tier / paywall	Monetization should follow product-market fit. If implemented too early, growth suffers.	**Future Phase**
Mentor payment processing	Unlocks revenue for senior mentors and a platform transaction fee. Complex to build safely.	**Future Phase**
Event impact showcase	Speakers/hosts can showcase lasting impact; organizers can market future events using connection data.	**Future Phase**

07: Success Metrics & KPIs

KPIs were defined in Miro before the build began, ensuring that the prototype was scoped around measurable outcomes, not just features. Launch targets were set modestly to reflect hackathon scale.

Full Metrics Framework

Acquisition	App downloads/installs; sign-up & registration rate; premium membership conversion rate (unpaid → paid)
Activation	Onboarding completion rate; time to first key action (first Sparkle logged); role selection completion
Engagement	Contacts logged per event; mentorship match rate; mentor/mentee 30-minute call completion rate; DAU / MAU / QAU; push notification open rate
Retention	Churn rate; return rate across multiple events; repeat mentor-mentee session rate
Trust & NPS	NPS (member ratings); number of safety flags filed; number of reports resolved
Technical	App crash rate; load time / latency; ANR (App Not Responding) rate; user reviews (numeric + qualitative)

08: Build Process & Technical Strategy

We used Lovable AI to generate and iterate on the prototype. The tool charges credits per prompt run.

Prompt Engineering Framework

I created a four-part structure for every Lovable prompt, with each section owned by a different team member. This mirrored our Miro PRD structure directly:

Section 1 — Context & Goals	Who the user is, what the product does, and what success looks like (owned by Priscilla)
Section 2 — User Journey	Step-by-step flows for each persona, converted from Miro diagrams to bullet points (owned by Trinity)
Section 3 — Technical Specs	Data models, integrations, auth, permissions, and API placeholders (owned by all)
Section 4 — Design & Styling	Visual direction, color palette, night-sky aesthetic, component patterns (owned by Shirley)

Scoped Bug Fixes

When a critical login flow bug appeared two days before demo, I wrote a tightly scoped fix prompt describing exactly which screens to change, with an explicit instruction not to touch any unrelated infrastructure. The constraint language was as important as the fix instructions.

09: What We Shipped

The final prototype included five fully functional user flows accessible via shared link to external judges:

01	**Guided Onboarding**	Teaches the Star/Sparkle/Constellation metaphor from the first screen. Role selection (Attendee, Mentee, Mentor), product tour, and mentorship survey for relevant roles.
02	**Event-Based Connection Logging**	Select an event, find a person, log the Sparkle using guided prompts — what stood out, what you talked about, connection strength, and follow-up notes. Drafts saved to home page.
03	**Constellation Visualization**	Visual star map per event. Stronger connections appear larger and more highlighted. Tap any star to view notes, profile, and follow-up actions. Sortable by date, topic, or industry.
04	**Mentor Matching**	Swipe-style card interface for discovering mentors/mentees. Compatibility percentage based on survey responses. Request flow

		with short intro message. Mentors see pending requests, not suggested matches.
05	**Organizer Dashboard**	Admin view for conference leads: attendee lists, engagement metrics with WAU/MAU toggle, connection counts, event management tools, and feedback summaries.

10: Key Product Decisions

Escalated safety to P0

Safety was originally scoped as P1. Mid-session I pushed to move it to P0 after naming our users explicitly: women, often early in their careers, in vulnerable mentorship relationships. The Miro PRD flagged this as a gap requiring security analysis. My call was to treat it as a non-negotiable foundation, not a future phase.

Cut LinkedIn OAuth, payments, and video calling

Multiple team members advocated for these throughout the week. My position: judges care about the experience after login, not how they log in. Cutting them wasn't a failure — it was what allowed the constellation visualization and mentor matching flows to be polished instead of rough. These lived in the PRD as clearly labeled future phases.

Standalone app over embedded integration

A question arose about embedding within the existing Women in Product app. My call: standalone for the hackathon, with Circle/WIP integration as a future phase. Embedding in another platform in 5 days is a recipe for a broken demo.

Conservative credit strategy over fast iteration

After losing 91 credits in one session, I slowed individual iteration speed to protect the team. No one runs prompts in the shared workspace until their section is finalized. Slower feedback loops, but no catastrophic loss.

Miro-first, then Lovable

I insisted the team complete the PRD, user journeys, and feature prioritization in Miro before writing a single Lovable prompt. This decision felt slow at first — but it was what made the final prompts specific enough to produce a real product. Teams that skipped planning and went straight to AI prototyping produced generic outputs.

11: Lessons Learned

From our hackathon retrospective and personal reflection:

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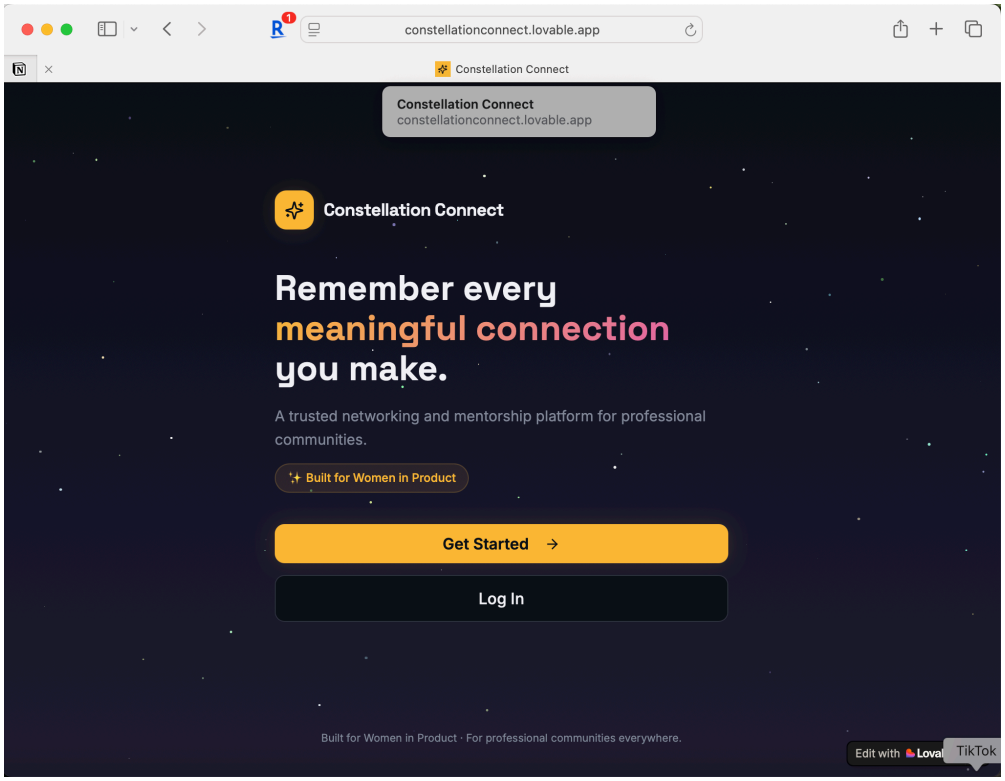
Plan before you prompt	The Miro PRD was the most valuable thing we built. Teams that skipped planning and went straight to Lovable produced generic outputs. The AI amplified our structure instead of replacing it.
Constraints force better decisions	The 100-credit limit made every feature decision important. Resource constraints are a design tool, not just a project management problem.
Safety is a product value, not a feature	Moving safety to P0 changed how the whole team thought about the product. Naming who we were building for — women in vulnerable mentorship situations — made every decision clearer.
Psychological safety makes teams fast	We moved quickly because any disagreement never became personal. Anchoring every debate to the user and keeping the eng goal in mind kept us productive across 5 days and 3 time zones.
Diverse teams build better products	Every user journey gap we caught, every edge case we surfaced, came from a lived experience one of us brought to the table. The team's diversity wasn't background context — it was a product input.

12: The App Look (just a few highlights)

Welcome Page:



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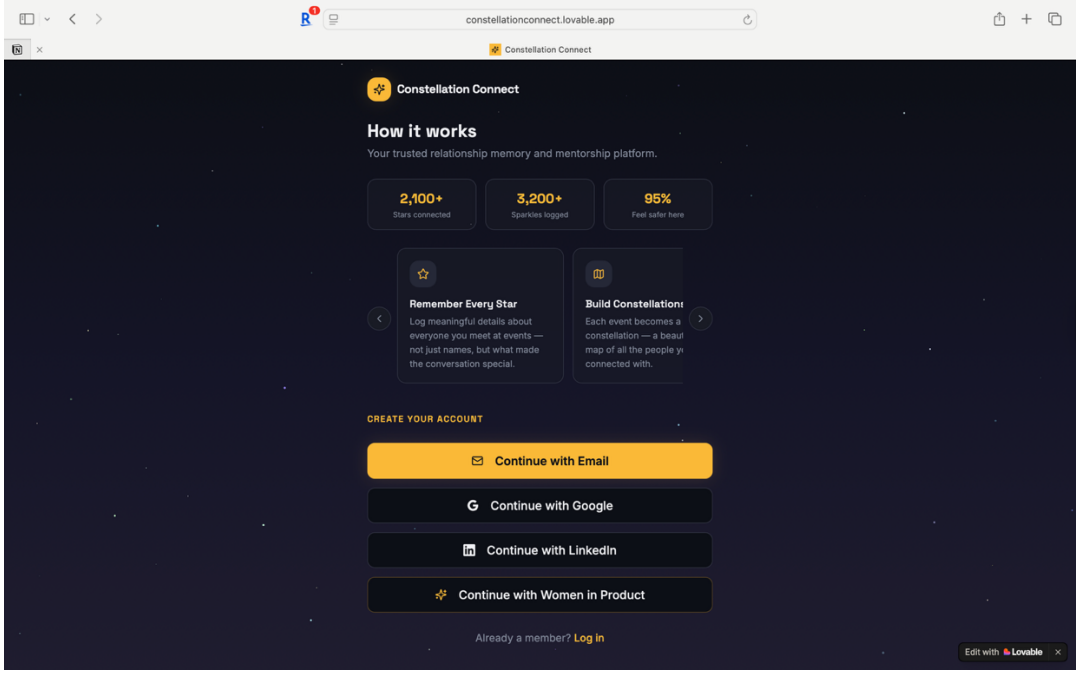
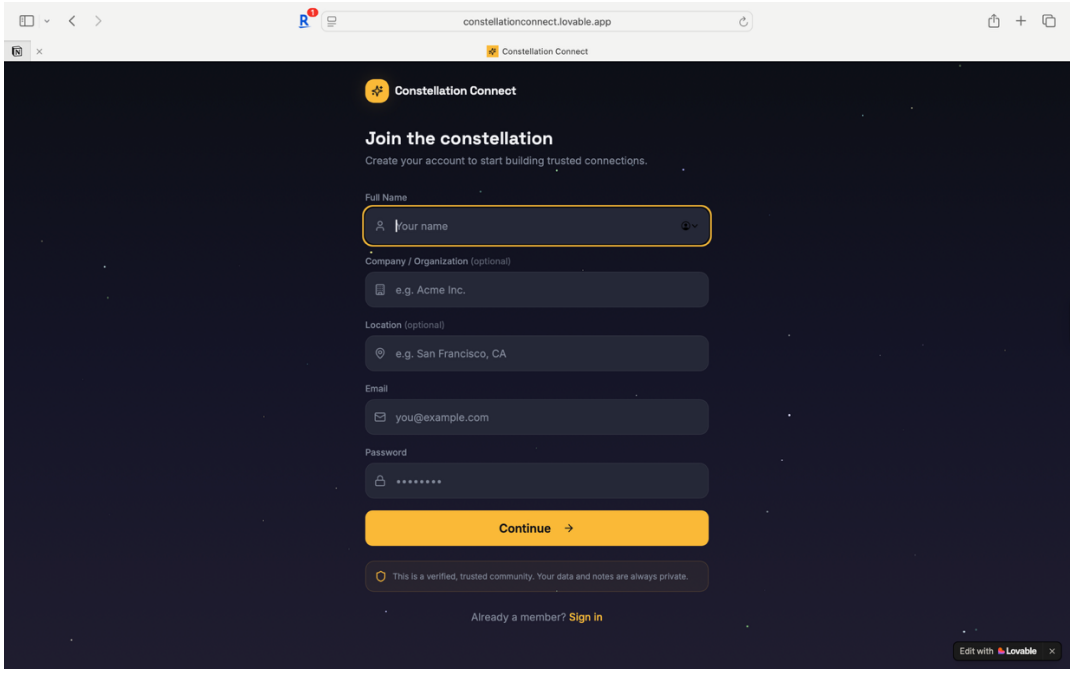
Create account page + instructions:



Sign-up page:



Connections overview:

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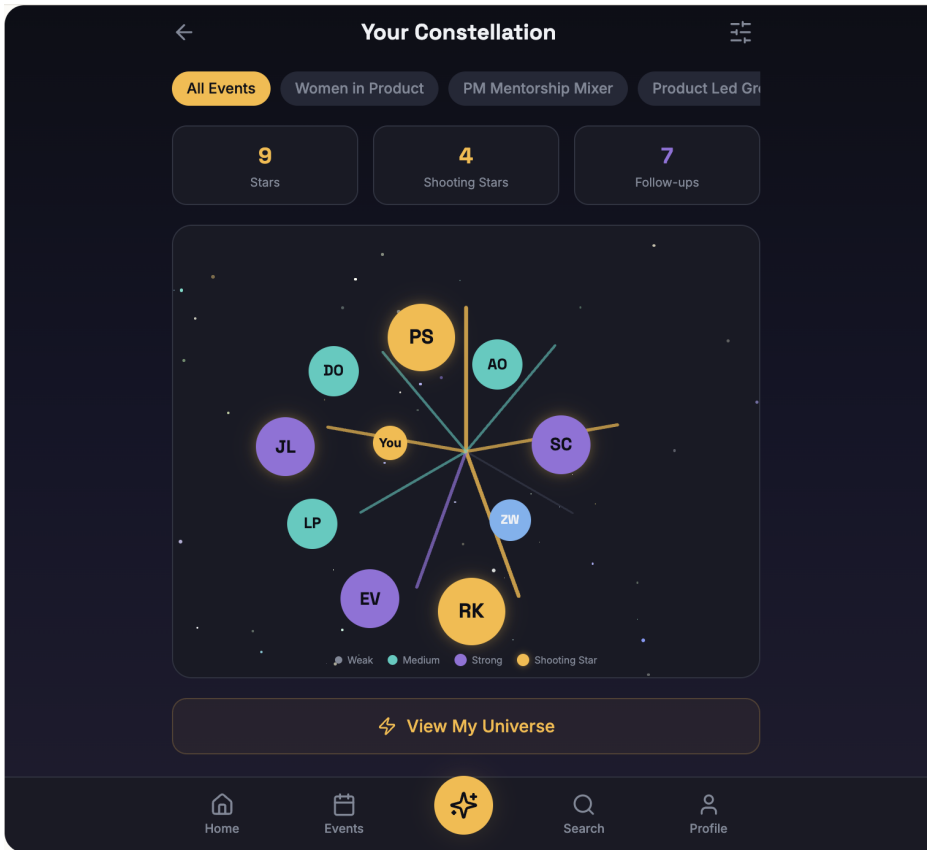
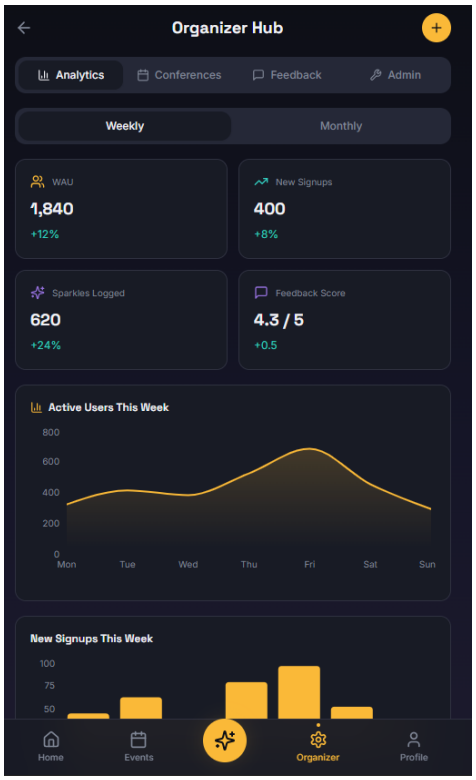


Analytics/Dashboard (Event Organizer View):



13: Future Roadmap

Constellation Connect was deliberately scoped for the hackathon. The following phases represent what a real product buildout would look like:

Phase 2	LinkedIn & Google OAuth login; calendar integration (Google Calendar / Outlook); video meeting links (Zoom, Google Meet, Teams); QR code scanning for fast conference contact capture
Phase 3	AI-generated follow-up message drafts from Sparkle notes; smart mentor matching using interaction history and skills alignment; profile completeness scoring
Phase 4	Premium tier paywall; mentor payment processing; coaching and accountability features; community access gating with verified Women in Product membership
Phase 5	Multi-community support beyond Women in Product; Circle platform integration; end-of-year constellation recap (Spotify Wrapped-style); event impact showcase for speakers and hosts

13: Links & Resources

Live Prototype	constellationconnect.lovable.app
Hackathon	Women in Product Hackathon — March 2026
Team	Priscilla (Me), Shirley, Trinity, Brandi
Tools	Lovable AI, Miro, Google Docs, Zoom, Perplexity AI, Gamma AI
Submission	Wednesday March 26, 2026

Remember every meaningful connection you make.

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